United Nations A/HRC/WG.6/53/GRC/3

General Assembly

Distr.: General
11 August 2026

Original: English

Human Rights Council
Working Group on the Universal Periodic Review
Fifty-third session
Geneva, 2–13 November 2026

Summary of stakeholders' submissions on Greece*

Report of the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights

I. Background

1. The present report was prepared pursuant to Human Rights Council resolutions 5/1 and 16/21, taking into consideration the periodicity of the universal periodic review and the outcome of the previous review.[1] It is a summary of 25 stakeholders' submissions[2] for the universal periodic review, presented in a summarized manner owing to word-limit constraints.

II. Information provided by stakeholders

A. Scope of international obligations[3] and cooperation with human rights mechanisms

2. TSA recommended that Greece ratify the ICRMW.[4]

3. JS8 recommended that Greece sign and ratify Protocol 4 to the European Convention on Human Rights within 12 months, prohibiting collective expulsion of third country nationals under Article 4.[5] ELEN recommended to ratify Protocol 12 of the European Convention on Human Rights.[6]

4. ELEN recommended that Greece ratify the European Charter for Regional or Minority Languages and the Framework Convention for National Minorities for all of its national and linguistic minorities.[7]

5. ICAN recommended that Greece ratifies the United Nations Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons.[8]

6. The Commissioner of the Council of Europe (CoE Commissioner) visited Greece in February 2025.[9]

* The present document is being issued without formal editing.

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B. National human rights framework

1. Constitutional and legislative framework

7. JS6 and JS7 considered that the punitive conditions of the alternatives to military service in Greece violated several human rights instruments.[10] JS6 recommended that Greece consider changes in legislation and practice in order to ensure that all individuals who express conscientious objection to compulsory military service on the grounds of conscience and/or religion do not face harassment or prosecution, and that they all have the opportunity, without discrimination, to perform civilian service of equal length to the one of military service. It also recommended to amend legislation in order for conscientious objectors to be able to perform alternative civilian service in their place of residence.[11]

2. Institutional infrastructure and policy measures

8. To ensure the effective implementation of UPR recommendations, APGXXIII recommended that Greece establish a permanent government mechanism to coordinate with relevant ministries and consult with civil society, National Human Rights Institutions and all relevant stakeholders.[12]

C. Promotion and protection of human rights

1. Implementation of international human rights obligations, taking into account applicable international humanitarian law

Equality and non-discrimination

9. OSCE-ODIHR recognized Greece's efforts to develop the 2nd National Action Plan against Racism and Intolerance (2025–2027). However, it underlined that Greece would benefit from building the capacity of prosecutors and judges to address hate crimes.[13]

Right to life, liberty and security of person, and freedom from torture

10. The European Committee for the Prevention of Torture and Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment recommended urgent improvements focusing on reducing cell occupancy, investing in maintenance, improving hygiene, and expanding the range of activities on offer to prisoners. That Committee also called for a coherent strategy to reduce the prison population, which should prioritise alternatives to imprisonment and non-custodial measures.[14]

Right to an adequate standard of living

11. To provide low-income families with free school meals, housing assistance and healthcare, JS2 recommended to fully implement and adequately fund the National Strategy for Social Integration and Poverty Reduction to address the root causes of family economic instability.[15]

Fundamental freedoms and the right to participate in public and political life

12. OSCE-ODIHR draw attention to the need that criminal provisions for defamation and insult be replaced by proportional civil remedies.[16]

13. ECLJ underlined that Greece’s ban on proselytization was in contravention of numerous international instruments, such as the UDHR and the ICCPR. It urged Greece to reform its laws to fully guarantee religious freedom for all its citizens, remove the ban on proselytizing, and allow its citizens to freely and peacefully share their faith with others.[17]

14. OSCE-ODIHR stressed that political parties should review their internal policies to promote women’s participation as candidates and give them prominence in the political parties’ campaigns.[18]

Prohibition of all forms of slavery, including trafficking in persons

15. TSA indicated that, even though Greece had strengthened its anti-trafficking law enforcement, specialized anti-trafficking units continued to face resource and staffing constraints, limiting proactive investigations.[19] TSA also underlined that the Office of the National Rapporteur on Human Trafficking lacked sufficient means and remained headed by an interim rapporteur since 2021.[20] TSA and JS9 recommended that Greece strengthen the capacity of first-line responders, including immigration authorities, to consistently identify victims of trafficking among vulnerable populations, including unaccompanied children, migrants, asylum seekers, refugees, and individuals engaged in commercial sex.[21] TSA also recommended to designate a permanent National Rapporteur on Human Trafficking and provide sufficient resources to support the Office of the National Rapporteur on Human Trafficking.[22]

16. JS3 indicated that the Greek asylum authorities identifying elements of human trafficking while conducting vulnerability assessments, should report the cases to the National Referral Mechanism for victims of human trafficking. Nevertheless, registration with the National Referral Mechanism was frequently ignored or insufficiently considered in the assessment of asylum claims and there was limited provision of essential support to victims, such as safe accommodation, psychological assistance, and specialised counselling.[23] The CoE Commissioner recommended that Greece ensure that interviews with child victims of trafficking are conducted as soon as possible after the offence and that, where it is indispensable to interview the victim more than once, interviews are conducted by the same person and under the same material conditions, upholding the same child-friendly procedural safeguards.[24]

Right to work and to just and favourable conditions of work

17. EUROMIL advocated for improvements in the working conditions of military personnel.[25]

Right to education

18. JS2 pointed at the educational load, stress and emotional burden on students. JS2 recommended to strengthen psychological school support and prevention and protection mechanisms in schools and online.[26]

2. Rights of specific persons or groups

Children

19. ADF International indicated that, despite being legally framed as an altruistic practice, surrogacy procedures in Greece revealed a reality where economic necessity, weak oversight and coercion interconnected, resulting in the reproductive exploitation of vulnerable women. Law 5197/2025, adopted in 2025, introduced amendments to the surrogacy framework and imposed new eligibility criteria for surrogacy.[27] ADF International and Juristes pour l'enfance considered that surrogacy was contrary to Greece's international human rights obligations, in particular article 20(a) of the OP-CRC-SC which Greece was party to.[28] These organizations recommended that Greece prohibit surrogacy in all its forms, amend article 1460 of the Civil Code to ensure full compliance with Greece's obligation under the CRC, recognize the birth mother of a child as the legal mother in all cases and establish effective justice mechanisms.[29]

Persons with disabilities

20. AcAs highlighted the difficulties faced by persons with disabilities in accessing healthcare. It recommended to improve access by reducing reliance on out-of-the-pocket expenditures and expanding coverage for essential services. It further encouraged the implementation of safeguards to prevent catastrophic health expenditures and ensure equitable access to care across all socioeconomic groups.[30]

21. AcAs reported that the tax structures on consumption created difficulties for persons with disabilities as an economically disadvantaged group. It recommended that Greece

implement targeted fiscal reforms to reduce the economic burden of VAT on persons with disabilities.[31]

Indigenous Peoples and minorities

22. ABTTF indicated that Greece rejected the ethnic identity of the Turkish community in Western Thrace on the grounds that the 1923 Treaty of Lausanne already referred to a "Muslim minority".[32] ABTTF pointed at the hate speech directed at the Turkish community in Western Thrace both in politics and the media.[33] ABTTF recommended that Greece recognize the ethnic Turkish identity of the Turkish community in Western Thrace and guarantee their freedom to form associations, executing the relevant ECtHR judgments promptly, fully and without exception.[34]

23. ELEN recommended that Greece ensure that any defamation, stigmatization or hate speech against persons belonging to national and linguistic minorities is fully investigated and prohibited by law.[35] ABTTF and WOLAS recommended to condemn and punish defamation, stigmatization and hate speech against persons belonging to national minorities, human rights defenders and NGOs.[36]

24. ABTTF indicated that the austerity measures imposed by the government, which included the temporary suspension and subsequent permanent closure of Turkish primary schools, were also applied to Turkish schools belonging to the Turkish community in Western Thrace. This decision became a systematic tool of discrimination.[37] ELEN added that the school boards of the Turkish schools had been progressively restricted by Greek authorities.[38] ABTTF and WOLAS stressed that the educational autonomy of the Turkish community must be restored, and decisions regarding Turkish schools must be returned to that community in accordance with its autonomy status.[39] ABTTF recommended that Greece fully respect the status of the Turkish community in Western Thrace and their rights in the field of education, including education in their mother tongue.[40] ELEN recommended that Greece recognize the ethnic Turkish identity of the Turkish community in Western Thrace and guarantee their rights to education are fully respected, and that their right to Turkish-medium education and access to quality education is guaranteed. It also recommended that the Turkish community is fully empowered to establish and manage its own schools.[41]

25. ABTTF and WOLAS stated that Greece should cease its interference in the religious affairs of the Turkish community and recognize the minority's elected muftis.[42] According to ABTTF, law No. 4964/2022 should be repealed, and the functioning of the mufti offices should be determined by the community itself.[43] ABTTF recommended that Greece respect the right to freedom of religion of the Turkish community in Western Thrace including the determination of their own religious leaders and to manage their religious institutions.[44]

26. The CoE Commissioner welcomed the National Strategy and Action Plan for the Social Inclusion of Roma 2021-2030.[45] OSCE-ODIHR expressed concern about the alarming situation of Roma children being out of formal education.[46] That Commissioner recommended that Greece accelerate the implementation of the National Strategy and Action Plan. According to the CoE Commissioner, coordination of national, regional and local authorities to implement the existing policies should be enhanced and the implementation of Local Action Plans should be better monitored.[47]

27. The CoE Commissioner stressed that access to adequate housing and related essential services was particularly challenging in a context where most Roma lived in poor conditions in settlements or de facto segregated neighbourhoods.[48] The CoE Commissioner also urged to ensure that all Roma settlements are connected to the water and electricity grids, and to refrain from forcibly evicting Roma from their settlements without provision of sustainable and adequate alternative housing solutions.[49]

28. OSCE-ODIHR expressed concern regarding allegations of violence against Roma during law-enforcement operations and several anti-Roma incidents.[50] The CoE Commissioner recommended to ensure prompt and effective investigations into all allegations of violence, racism and discrimination against Roma, with due consideration to any possible racist motive.[51]

Lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender and intersex persons

29. JS5 reported that Greece adopted legislation legalizing same-sex marriage and the adoption for same-sex couples in 2024, prohibiting so-called "conversion therapies" for vulnerable individuals, and enacted laws addressing discrimination and bullying based on SOGIESC. Despite these advances, LGBTIQ+ individuals in Greece continued to experience discrimination, harassment, and an alarming escalation in hate-motivated violence, as well as discrimination in healthcare settings.[52]

30. Intersex GR highlighted the adoption of the 2021 National Strategy for Equality of LGBTQI+ persons and several legislative measures taken by Greece to include sex characteristics within its legal framework.[53] JS5 recommend to effectively implement the action plan for the national LGBTIQ+ Equality Strategy, including clear timelines, budgets, and monitoring mechanisms.[54]

31. Intersex GR and JS5 stressed the insufficient evidence of effective investigation, prosecution, and condemnation of hate speech and hate crimes targeting intersex persons. In practice, stigma, hostility, and degrading treatment remained widespread, especially within the medical sector.[55] Intersex GR recommended that Greece take concrete measures to investigate, document, prosecute, and publicly condemn hate speech, hate crimes, and degrading treatment targeting intersex persons, including abuses occurring in healthcare settings. It also recommended to ensure that protection against hate speech and hate crimes on the ground includes intersex persons explicitly.[56] JS5 recommended to amend the Anti-Racist Law (Law 4285/2014) as well as parliamentary regulations to lift political immunity for parliamentarians and high-ranking public officials who engage in SOGIESC-based hate speech or incitement to violence, ending the current culture of high-level institutional immunity.[57] JS5 recommended that Greece implement robust and specialized training to combat bias for law enforcement officers responding to allegations of violence, hate crimes, and hate speech against individuals because of their actual or perceived SOGIESC.[58]

32. JS5 and Intersex GR recommended to establish compulsory and continuous training programmes for healthcare professionals on LGBTIQ+ inclusion and rights and to mitigate social prejudices, stigmatization, harassment, discrimination, and violence against individuals because of their actual or perceived SOGIESC.[59]

33. Intersex GR underlined that Law 4958/2022 prohibited medically unnecessary sex-normalising procedures on intersex minors under the age of 15 and introduced sanctions for doctors who unlawfully perform such interventions. Intersex GR indicated a lack of implementation of this reform therefore substantially weakening its protective value.[60] Intersex GR recommended that Greece fully implement Law 4958/2022 by establishing, within a clear timeframe, the interdisciplinary committee required under its Article 18 and by issuing binding implementation protocols to all hospitals and healthcare providers.[61] JS5 recommended to draft and adopt legislation closing the loopholes in Law 4958/2022 to strictly and unconditionally prohibit non-medically necessary interventions aimed at altering or modifying intersex minors' sex characteristics.[62] JS5 also recommended to abolish the mandatory psychiatric evaluation and the requirement for approval by the multi-disciplinary medical committee for minors aged 15–17 seeking legal gender recognition, ensuring a process free from medical gatekeeping.[63]

34. Intersex GR and JS5 stated that intersex persons faced discrimination in educational settings and intersex issues were absent from school curricula and sexuality education, contributing to shame, invisibility and misinformation.[64] JS5 indicated that, in 2023, Greece passed the Law 5029 on preventing and responding to school violence and bullying, yet its implementation had stalled.[65] Intersex GR recommended that Greece integrate accurate, rights-based and age-appropriate information on sex characteristics and bodily diversity into school curricula, sexuality education, and anti-bullying programmes.[66]

Migrants, refugees and asylum-seekers

35. Several submissions alerted that, in July 2025, the submission of asylum applications by third-country nationals entering Greek territory by sea was suspended for a period of three months. The suspension allowed the return, without registration, of persons arriving in their country of origin or provenance.[67] APGXXIII underlined that this measure was incompatible

with EU laws, the Charter of Fundamental Rights and the 1951 Geneva Convention.[68] JS3 recommended that Greece desist from any suspension of asylum applications and ensure full and non-discriminatory access to asylum procedures for all individuals, including prompt registration, provision of interpretation and legal assistance, and individualised assessments in line with international and EU law.[69]

36. In October 2025, the three-month suspension ended but obstacles in exercising the right to asylum persisted, especially for migrants arriving from countries considered safe.[70] The CoE Commissioner urged members of the Greek parliament to reject an amendment providing for the suspension of the registration of asylum applications from persons arriving by boat from North Africa, as well as for their forcible return, without registration, to their country of origin or provenance. The Commissioner stressed that this proposal would legalise returning people to face a risk of torture and other serious violations, in breach of obligations under the European Convention on Human Rights, the 1951 Refugee Convention, and other instruments.[71]

37. JS3 and ASSEDEL expressed concern because the right to access asylum was undermined by the application of the "safe third country" principle. Greek authorities had largely failed to consider up-to-date and reliable information on the risks of inhuman or degrading treatment and refoulement in a neighbouring country.[72]

38. Several contributions reported consistent pushbacks of migrants and systematic summary expulsions without access to asylum procedures.[73] APGXXIII recommended that Greece ensure full and fair access to the right to asylum for all people on the move, and guarantee compliance with the principle of non-refoulement.[74] The CoE Commissioner recommended adopting a zero-tolerance approach to summary returns and other human rights violations, ensuring that allegations of such practices are effectively investigated and that all persons being subjected to border control operations have adequate access to individualised procedures to raise protection needs, as well as to effective remedies.[75] SU and JS9 recommended to immediately cease pushbacks operations and allow for fair and transparent asylum procedures.[76]

39. JS4 recommended that Greece develop and implement a comprehensive legal pathway for the regularisation and social integration of migrants and asylum seekers residing in Greece, including access to documentation, employment, housing, healthcare, and education, recognising that the absence of regular status perpetuates conditions of vulnerability, exploitation, and social exclusion incompatible with Greece's obligations under international human rights law.[77]

40. Several submissions alerted that the new online platform to apply for asylum, introduced in 2022, required a detention period of up to 25 days for the procedure to be finalized, thereby restricting the freedom of movements for asylum-seekers while leaving undocumented individuals without basic healthcare, accommodation or essential services for extended periods.[78] JS3 recommended that Greece ensure effective access to asylum by establishing a fully functional and accessible registration system, guaranteeing accurate nationality assessments, ensuring access to free legal aid, and ensuring fair, in-person and individualised examinations.[79]

41. JS3 expressed serious concerns because most interviews were conducted remotely, with applicants connecting from reception facilities and caseworkers and interpreters joining online. This had a detrimental impact on the quality of the interview, the guarantee of a meaningful communication, and to properly assess credibility and handling of traumatic experiences.[80] In addition, JS3 indicated that the Greek law provided that the interview and the decision should normally be conducted by the same case officer except in situations of large-scale arrivals. However, this exception had become routine. JS3 raised concern about the credibility assessments, as decision-makers relied solely on the written record without having attended the interview.[81] JS8 recommended that Greece ensure that all individuals apprehended at its land and sea borders are provided with individual assessment of their protection needs before any return is enacted, in compliance with Article 33 of the 1951 Refugee Convention, Article 3 CAT, and Article 7 ICCPR.[82]

42. JS3 expressed concern about the lack of legal assistance in the asylum procedure, as no state-funded legal aid was available at first instance of the procedure and support relied

on overstretched civil society organisations. State-funded legal aid scheme operated at the appeal stage since 2017 and was gradually improving in the share of appeals supported. However, its capacity and the quality of the service remained insufficient.[83] Furthermore, access to justice after a second-instance rejection remained a major challenge, as the process was lengthy and costly.[84] JS9 recommended that Greece guarantee that all return decisions are subject to effective judicial review, with access to legal remedies and safeguards.[85]

43. JS3 and APGXXIII alerted that, since the Ministry of Migration and Asylum (MoMA) assumed the responsibility, cash assistance to asylum-seekers suffered from delays and inconsistencies.[86] JS3 indicated that interpretation services faced significant disruptions. As a result, asylum interviews were postponed or cancelled, and appeals and subsequent applications were halted, leaving many applicants in legal limbo without access to essential protection services.[87] SU recommended that Greece restore cash assistance.[88] JS3 recommended to immediately ensure the provision of cash assistance and interpretation services to all asylum seekers, including retroactive payments, regular and timely future payments, and the sustained provision of translation services.[89]

44. JS4 and TSA reported that Greek civil society organizations, and migrant rights organizations in particular, were under pressure from public authorities.[90] For instance, the NGO registry introduced in 2020 established a mandatory registration system as a prerequisite for any organization wishing to operate in reception facilities or engage with public authorities. Greek authorities have threatened to remove NGOs from the official registry if they opposed state migration policies, challenged decisions or misused funds.[91] Furthermore, legislative developments in late 2025 and early 2026 have dramatically escalated their severity.[92] The misuse of criminal law has been the most visible and damaging tool deployed against migrants' rights defenders.[93] The CoE Commissioner expressed a similar concern.[94] JS4 recommended to reform the NGO Registry framework to bring it into conformity with international standards on freedom of association.[95]

45. JS4 recommended that Greece adopt comprehensive legislation establishing clear legal protections for human rights defenders, including lawyers, humanitarian workers, journalists, and civil society actors working in the field of migration and asylum, ensuring that the provision of humanitarian assistance and legitimate human rights monitoring activities cannot be prosecuted as criminal offences under anti-smuggling or related provisions of the Migration Code. It also recommended to repeal the provisions of the 2026 Law on the Promotion of Legal Migration Policies that designate membership in a registered NGO as an aggravating circumstance for offences under Articles 24 and 25 of the Migration Code.[96]

46. JS4 recommended to ensure prompt, impartial, thorough, and transparent investigations into all reported attacks, threats, acts of intimidation, and judicial harassment directed against human rights defenders, and guarantee that perpetrators — including public officials — are held accountable in accordance with the rule of law and Greece's international obligations.[97] TSA recommended that Greece amend its legislation to ensure humanitarian assistance is not criminalised and fully protect freedom of association and expression.[98]

47. APGXXIII stated that xenophobic manifestations from Greek authorities were recorded.[99] JS8 recommended that Greece, within 12 months, conduct an independent inquiry into documented incidents of state actors using racist and dehumanising language during border and detention operations, and publish findings with accountability measures.[100] The CoE Commissioner indicated that, while steps had been taken to foster accountability, problems persisted in carrying out effective investigations. It underlined that Greek authorities should undertake a review of existing accountability mechanisms competent for investigating and responding to human rights violations against refugees, asylum seekers and migrants and address the shortcomings affecting their effectiveness and independence. The Commissioner also called on the Greek authorities to ensure that national human rights bodies have the capacity to monitor and report about asylum seekers and migrants at borders.[101]

48. JS3 reported that Greek asylum authorities routinely failed to identify, protect, and fairly assess the claims of survivors of gender-based violence (GBV), despite Greece having signed the Istanbul Convention and recognized GBV as a reason for asylum.[102] JS3

recommended that Greece ensure gender-sensitive and trauma-informed asylum procedures by systematically identifying survivors of GBV and trafficking, guaranteeing their access to interpretation, legal aid, and specialised support services, and ensuring that all relevant vulnerability indicators and National Referral Mechanism findings are effectively assessed in asylum decisions.[103] JS8 recommended that Greece adopt and implement, within 12 months, a protocol for the documentation and investigation of all allegations of sexual and gender-based violence committed during border operations.[104] JS8 recommended that Greece, within six months, ensure that all women and girls in reception facilities and detention have access to safe reporting mechanisms for GBV that do not require engagement with the same authorities accused of perpetrating violations.[105] JS8 also recommended that Greece, within 12 months, extend the national GBV action plan to explicitly cover women in camps, reception facilities, and irregular migration situations, with designated GBV coordinators at each facility and independently monitored.[106]

49. APGXXIII recommended that Greece implement measures to raise awareness among authorities involved in asylum determination procedures, regarding the female genital mutilation. It also recommended to include clearer dispositions in the legal Greek framework that guarantee a broader approach to the recognition of all victims of female genital mutilation.[107]

50. JS3 reported that, following the closure of the ESTIA programme in 2022, Greece faced a critical gap in suitable housing for vulnerable asylum-seekers.[108] Vulnerable groups such as women, single mothers, pregnant women, unaccompanied minors, and persons with disabilities are often housed with unrelated men or in inappropriate accommodations, increasing risks of violence and abuse.[109] APGXXIII recommended to provide alternative housing solutions that take into account vulnerabilities identified during the registration.[110]

51. ASSEDEL reported that the reception facilities in Greece resembled to prisons rather than humanitarian centres designed to provide care and protection with physical conditions echoing a punitive model.[111] SU added that reception conditions for refugees in Greece were severely deficient in quality and produced unsafe environments for women and children.[112] TSA recommended that all reception facilities meet international human rights standards by reducing overcrowding and guaranteeing adequate living conditions.[113] JS8 recommended that Greece, within six months, ensure that all pre-removal detention centres comply with the Nelson Mandela Rules.[114] APGXXIII recommended that Greece improve its reception facilities for migrants, ensuring adequate hygiene and sanitation conditions, access to health care and psychological support in accordance with international standards.[115]

52. ASSEDEL reported that Reception and Identification Centres were often overcrowded receiving migrants in conditions widely criticized.[116] Under the 2021 asylum reform, Greece significantly altered the operational model of these centres by converting them into Closed Controlled Access Centres (CCACs) as closed, heavily securitized where freedom of movement of residents was severely restricted, making them detention-like environments.[117] TSA recommended to expand access to high-quality specialized services, such as shelter and psychosocial support, for all victims, including children, adult males, rural populations, and individuals in CCACs and Reception and Identification Centres (RICs).[118]

53. Some contributions informed that, in the RICs and in the CCACs on the islands, some minors lived in conditions equivalent to detention for over 120 days without the ability to leave. Age assessment procedures were often uncertain and inconsistent, sometimes without carrying out evidentiary clinical examinations.[119] These conditions prompted multiple rulings from Greek courts declaring such confinement constitutive of detention and attracted interim measures from the European Court of Human Rights.[120] APGXXIII recommended to progressively abolish the conditions equivalent to detention in these centres, while reinforcing non-custodial alternatives and community-based reception solutions.[121]

54. SU reported strides made by Greece to pass legislation guaranteeing the rights and protection of refugee children. However, their implementation was insufficient.[122] ASSEDEL and JS1 indicated that unaccompanied and separated minors were not held in officially designated detention centres but confined in “safe zones” or “protective custody” areas within CCACs and RICs.[123] APGXXIII and SU recommended to strengthen specific protection pathways for unaccompanied minors and vulnerable people, ensuring that they are not placed

in unsuitable facilities or subjected to unsafe transfers.[124] SU, JS8 and JS9 recommended that Greece immediately cease the detention of unaccompanied children in police stations and adult facilities.[125] JS8 recommended that Greece ensure that families with children are placed in appropriate non-custodial accommodation and in accordance with the principle of the best interests of the child.[126]

55. APGXXIII reported that the refugee camps entailed significant violations of the European standards due to isolation of the camps and difficulties in accessing basic services.[127] This isolation and the lack of public transportation reduced job opportunities and increased the risk of exploitation, including labour exploitation.[128] APGXXIII recommended to ensure accessible transportation, with stops near the camps, regular and reliable services, and affordable fares in order to ensure freedom of movement for asylum seekers.[129]

56. APGXXIII recommended that Greece enable access for CSOs and NGOs to supply essential goods, monitor conditions, and provide legal assistance.[130] It also recommended to ensure that, upon arrival at reception centres, asylum seekers receive clear information regarding available services in the facility, obligations for maintaining reception conditions, legal system and access to healthcare, as provided for in Article 5 of Directive 2013/33/EU.[131]

57. Several contributions reported that although a national guardianship scheme was formally established in late 2023 with designated NGOs, its staffing remained critically below the needs. The shortage of guardians delayed access to legal representation, administrative support, and protection mechanisms such as family tracing and reunification. In addition, bureaucratic delays within relevant state offices and high turnover further undermined consistent and timely delivery of guardianship services.[132] APGXXIII and SU recommended that Greece ensure timely appointment and systematic training of guardians for unaccompanied foreign minors, with monitoring mechanisms of guardianship's quality.[133]

58. JS8 and JS9 recommended that Greece establish an independent border monitoring mechanism with a mandate to access all land and maritime border zones, staffed by representatives of national human rights institutions, UNHCR, and accredited civil society organisations. It also recommended for that body to publish quarterly public reports on incidents of forced return.[134] JS8 recommended to establish an independent complaints body with jurisdiction to receive and investigate allegations of pushbacks, torture, and enforced disappearance at the border, with the authority to refer cases for prosecution. It should publish annual data on complaints received, investigations initiated, and outcomes.[135]

59. JS1 indicated that the Greek judicial system did not provide an effective remedy to foreign nationals to contest the legality of their detention in structures like the CCACs.[136] JS8 recommended that Greece accept the individual complaints procedure under Article 31 of the ICPPED.[137]

Notes

[1] A/HRC/49/5, A/HRC/49/5/Add.1, and A/HRC/49/2.

[2] The stakeholders listed below have contributed information for this summary; the full texts of all original submissions are available at: www.ohchr.org (one asterisk denotes a national human rights institution with A status).

Civil society

Individual submissions:

ABTTF	Federation of Western Thrace Turks in Europe, Witten (Germany);
AcAs	AccessibilityAtlas, Jersey City (United States of America);
ADF International	ADF International, 1202 Geneva (Switzerland);
APGXXIII	Association "Comunità Papa Giovanni XXIII", Rimini (Italy);
ASSEDEL	Association Européenne des droits et des libertés, Strasbourg (France);
ECLJ	European Centre for Law and Justice, The, Strasbourg (France);
ELEN	European Language Equality Network, Brussels (Belgium);
EUROMIL	European Organisation of Military Associations and Trade Unions, Brussels (Belgium);

ICAN	International Campaign to Abolish Nuclear Weapons, Geneva (Switzerland);
Intersex GR	Intersex Greece, Athens (Greece);
Juristes pour l'enfance	Juristes pour l'enfance, Lyon (France);
SU	Solidarity & Unity, Markelo (Netherlands);
TSA	The Salvation Army, London (United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland);
WOLAS	Yeryüzü Avukatları Derneği, Istanbul (Türkiye).

Joint submissions:

JS1	**Joint submission 1 submitted by:** Joint initiative of Samos-based legal aid organisations for UPR-Greece 4th cycle, Samos (Greece); Avocats sans Frontières France (ASFF) - Samos Legal Centre Project;
JS2	**Joint submission 2 submitted by:** Marist International Solidarity Foundation, Rome (Italy); Marist Brothers – Province of L´Hermitage and The Leonteion Schools of Greece;
JS3	**Joint submission 3 submitted by:** Equal Legal Aid, Roubaix (France); Mobile Info Team;
JS4	**Joint submission 4 submitted by:** World Organisation Against Torture, Geneva (Switzerland); World Organisation against Torture and Greek Helsinki Monitor;
JS5	**Joint submission 5 submitted by:** Advocates for Human Rights, Minneapolis (United States of America); The Advocates for Human Rights; Thessaloniki Pride;
JS6	**Joint submission 6 submitted by:** Connection e.V., Offenbach (Germany); Connection e.V.War Resisters' International (WRI);
JS7	**Joint submission 7 submitted by:** European Bureau for Conscientious Objection, Brussels (Belgium); Association of Greek Conscientious Objectors (AGCO);
JS8	**Joint submission 8 submitted by:** Border Violence Monitoring Network (BVMN), Leipzig (Germany);
JS9	**Joint submission 9 submitted by:** Syrian center for media and freedom of expression, Paris (France).

Regional intergovernmental organization(s):

CoE	Council of Europe, Strasbourg Cedex (France);
OSCE-ODIHR	Office for Democratic Institutions and Human Rights/Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe, Warsaw (Poland).

[3] The following abbreviations are used in UPR documents:

ICCPR	International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights
CAT	Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment
CRC	Convention on the Rights of the Child
OP-CRC-SC	Optional Protocol to CRC on the sale of children, child prostitution and child pornography
ICRMW	International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Members of Their Families
ICPPED	International Convention for the Protection of All Persons from Enforced Disappearance

[4] TSA, p. 5.
[5] JS8, para. 8.4.
[6] ELEN, p. 4.
[7] ELEN, p. 4.
[8] ICAN, p. 1.
[9] CoE, para. 1.
[10] JS6, para 2 and JS7, para. 2.
[11] JS6, paras. 2, 6, 10 and 28. See also JS7, para. 65.
[12] APGXXIII, p. 5.
[13] OSCE-ODIHR, para. 8.

[14] CoE, para. 11. See also JS1, pp. 4–5.
[15] JS2, para. 49.
[16] OSCE-ODIHR, para. 6. See also ABTTF, p. 6; WOLAS, para. 31; and JS5, para. 51.
[17] ECLJ, paras. 11 and 15.
[18] OSCE-ODIHR, para. 6. See also ABTTF, p. 6; WOLAS, para. 31; and JS5, para. 51.
[19] TSA, paras. 8 and 10.
[20] TSA, para. 14.
[21] TSA, p. 5 and JS9, p. 13.
[22] TSA, p. 5.
[23] JS3, paras. 30–31. See also JS2, para. 56; SU, p. 3; and TSA, para. 11.
[24] CoE, para. 23.
[25] EUROMIL, p. 3.
[26] JS2, paras. 12–17, 33 and 43.
[27] ADF International, paras. 6 and 13.
[28] ADF International, paras. 21–33.
[29] ADF International, para. 34 and Juristes pour l'Enfance, pp. 2 and 5.
[30] AcAs, pp. 5–6.
[31] AcAs, pp. 3–4.
[32] ABTTF, paras. 7–9. See also Elen, p. 4.
[33] ABTTF, paras. 29–31.
[34] ABTTF, p. 5.
[35] Elen, p. 4.
[36] ABTTF, p. 6 and WOLAS, para. 31. See also JS5, para. 51.
[37] ABTTF, para. 19. See also Elen, para. 8 and WOLAS, paras. 18–22.
[38] Elen, paras. 8–11.
[39] ABTTF, para. 22 and WOLAS, paras. 27 and 32.
[40] ABTTF, p. 6.
[41] Elen, p. 4.
[42] ABTTF, para. 23 and WOLAS, paras. 11–12.
[43] ABTTF, para. 28.
[44] ABTTF, p. 6. See also WOLAS, paras. 28–29.
[45] CoE, para. 1.
[46] OSCE-ODIHR, para. 11.
[47] CoE, para. 1.
[48] CoE, para. 1.
[49] CoE, para. 1.
[50] OSCE-ODIHR, para. 12.
[51] CoE, para. 3. See also JS2, para. 53.
[52] JS5, paras. 1–4 and 9.
[53] Intersex GR, paras. 4–5.
[54] JS5, para. 6.
[55] Intersex GR, paras. 4–5, 8 and 14, and JS5, paras. 7, 11, 30–35 and 44–47.
[56] Intersex GR, p. 8.
[57] JS5, para. 51.
[58] JS5, para. 51.
[59] JS5, para. 51 and Intersex GR, p. 8.
[60] Intersex GR, paras. 9–13. See also JS5, para. 32.
[61] Intersex GR, p. 8. See also JS5, para. 13.
[62] JS5, para. 51.
[63] JS5, para. 51.
[64] Intersex GR, para. 18 and JS5, paras. 17–18.
[65] JS5, para. 15.
[66] Intersex GR, p. 8. See also JS5, para. 15.
[67] JS3, para. 33; APGXXIII, p. 1; SU, p. 2; TSA, para. 17; JS8, paras. 2.2.4, 4.10 and 6.4; and JS9, para. 11.
[68] APGXXIII, p. 1.
[69] JS3, para. 43. See also JS8, para. 8.12.
[70] APGXXIII, p. 1.
[71] CoE, para. 5.
[72] JS3, paras. 12–13 and ASSEDEL p. 7.
[73] Assedel, pp. 3 and 6; JS4, para. 5; JS8, paras. 2.2.1–2.2.2, 4.1–4.9 and 5.1; SU, pp. 2–3; TSA, para. 15; and JS9, paras. 6–9 and 35–42. See also CoE, para. 6.

[74] APGXXIII, p. 3.
[75] CoE, para. 6.
[76] SU, p. 4 and JS9, p. 12.
[77] JS4, para. 22. See also JS9, p. 13.
[78] JS3, paras. 5-6 and 14; JS1, p. 3; and JS8, para. 4.10.
[79] JS3, para. 45. See also TSA, p. 5.
[80] JS3, paras. 9–10.
[81] JS3, para. 11.
[82] JS8, para. 8.5. See also JS9, p. 13.
[83] JS3, paras. 15–17. See also JS1, pp. 9–10.
[84] JS3, para. 25.
[85] JS9, p. 13.
[86] JS3, para. 40 and APGXXIII, p. 2. See also SU, p. 3.
[87] JS3, paras. 15–17 and 41.
[88] SU, p. 4.
[89] JS3, para. 42.
[90] JS4, paras. 9–10 and TSA, para. 19. See also JS9, p. 5.
[91] JS4, paras. 8–9 and 13.
[92] JS4, paras. 5 and 13 and TSA, para. 18. See also APGXXII, p. 1.
[93] JS4, para. 11 and TSA, para. 19. See also JS5, para. 4.
[94] CoE, para. 8.
[95] JS4, para. 22. See also JS9, p. 14.
[96] JS4, para. 22. See also JS9, p. 14.
[97] JS4, para. 22. See also JS9, p. 14.
[98] TSA, p. 5.
[99] APGXXIII, p. 2. See also JS8, para. 2.2.5.
[100] JS8, para. 8.15. See also JS9, p. 13.
[101] CoE, para. 2. See also JS4, para. 6 and TSA, para. 16.
[102] JS3, para. 28. See also APGXXIII, p. 3; Assedel, p. 2; and JS8, para. 2.2.2.
[103] JS3, para. 44. See also SU, pp. 3–4.
[104] JS8, para. 8.6.
[105] JS8, para. 8.7.
[106] JS8, para. 8.8.
[107] APGXXIII, p. 3.
[108] JS3, para. 32. See also APGXXIII, p. 2 and JS8, para. 6.7.
[109] Assedel, pp. 3–4. See also JS1, p. 3; JS5, para. 28; TSA, paras. 10 and 21; and JS8, para. 6.11.
[110] APGXXIII, p. 4.
[111] Assedel, p. 2.
[112] SU, p. 3.
[113] TSA, p. 5.
[114] JS8, para. 8.10.
[115] APGXXIII, p. 3.
[116] Assedel, p. 3. See also CoE, paras. 10–11; SU, p. 3; and TSA, para. 21.
[117] Assedel, pp. 3–4. See also JS1, p. 3; JS5, para. 28; TSA, paras. 10 and 21; and JS8, para. 6.11.
[118] TSA, p. 5.
[119] APGXXIII, p. 4; SU, pp.3–4; Assedel, p. 6; and JS1, p. 7.
[120] APGXXIII, p. 4.
[121] APGXXIII, p. 4.
[122] SU, p. 4.
[123] Assedel, p. 5 and JS1, pp. 4 and 6–7.
[124] APGXXIII, p. 3 and SU, p. 2. See also JS8, para. 6.5.
[125] SU, p. 4; JS8, para. 8.9; and JS9, p. 13. See also JS8, para. 6.1 and JS9, para. 16.
[126] JS8, para. 8.11.
[127] APGXXIII, p. 2.
[128] APGXXIII, p. 3 and JS4, para. 7.
[129] APGXXIII, p. 4.
[130] APGXXIII, p. 3.
[131] APGXXIII, p. 3. See also SU, p. 3 and JS8, para. 2.2.3.
[132] APGXXIII, p. 4; Assedel, p. 6; JS1, pp. 3 and 7; and SU, p. 3. See also JS1, p.3.
[133] APGXXIII, p. 4 and SU, p. 4.
[134] JS8, para. 8.1 and JS9, p. 13.
[135] JS8, para. 8.2.

[136] JS1, p. 3.
[137] JS8, para. 8.3.